

CLAT Express - August 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Ceuta: geography, status and disputes

Ceuta is a small Spanish enclave on the northern coast of Africa. It is bordered on its land side by a neighbouring state, and a strong fence separates the enclave from that country. Many of those who arrive there are seeking work, education or a better life, while others are fleeing conflict or persecution in their home countries. Tensions over a distant territory add another layer to the story. Western Sahara, a former Spanish colony, has been the subject of a long dispute involving neighbouring countries and groups seeking self-determination. Changes in the relations between Spain and its neighbours have, at different times, affected how many people reach the enclave. Ceuta's story shows how geography and politics can combine. A place that is small on the map can become a major point of diplomacy when large numbers of people try to cross into it. Such episodes also test how well the rules protecting people who seek safety are applied in practice.

Q1.

Which body declared the Ceuta Migration Crisis resolved?

- (A) European Commission
- (B) United Nations Security Council
- (C) African Union
- (D) NATO

Q2.

What is the political status of Ceuta?

- (A) Autonomous City of Spain
- (B) French Overseas Territory
- (C) Independent City-State
- (D) UN Trust Territory

Q3.

At the eastern entrance of which strait is Ceuta strategically located?

- (A) Strait of Hormuz
- (B) Bosphorus Strait
- (C) Strait of Malacca
- (D) Strait of Gibraltar

Q4.

According to the booklet, how many land borders does the EU share with Africa?

- (A) One
- (B) Three
- (C) Four
- (D) Two

Q5.

Assertion (A): Fortified border fences separating Ceuta from Morocco are often breached by immigrants.

Reason (R): Ceuta lies on the Atlantic coast of Africa.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ceuta's political status	A. 1975
II. Ceuta's neighbouring country	B. 1976
III. Year Morocco annexed Western Sahara	C. Morocco
IV. Year Polisario Front declared SADR	D. Autonomous City of Spain

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q7.

Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- I. Ceuta's coast faces the Mediterranean Sea.
- II. Ceuta is an Autonomous City of Spain.
- III. Morocco accepts Spain's sovereignty over Ceuta and Melilla.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

Consider the following statements about Ceuta:

- I. It lies on the northern coast of Africa.
- II. It is one of the shortest routes into European territory from Africa.
- III. It lies at the western entrance of the Strait of Gibraltar.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Claims, Law and Disputes

The South China Sea has been a focus of competing territorial claims for many decades. Several countries around its shores assert rights over islands, reefs and surrounding waters, and their claims often overlap. The sea is also rich in resources and fishing grounds, which gives every claimant a practical reason to hold on to the features it controls.

After the Second World War, islands that Japanese forces had used for military purposes became part of the wider question of ownership. Claims were soon drawn on maps, and China's claim is commonly described through a boundary line marked on official maps. That line continued to appear on official maps even after the Chinese Communist Party came to power, and it covers a large share of the sea.

A United Nations convention on the law of the sea sets a legal framework that tries to balance the interests of coastal states and seafaring nations. Although the countries involved have signed and ratified it, its interpretation in this sea remains fiercely disputed. In the early 2000s, ASEAN and China agreed on a declaration meant to manage and resolve disputes.

Disputes have also gone to international bodies. The Philippines brought its case to an arbitral tribunal, arguing that China's claims violated its sovereignty. The tribunal ruled against China, which rejected the ruling and said it preferred bilateral negotiations with the other parties involved. Overlapping claims continue to shape naval activity, fishing and access to resources in the region.

Q1.

Which treaty required Imperial Japan to give up territories it had conquered during World War II?

- (A) Treaty of San Francisco (1951)
- (B) Treaty of Versailles
- (C) Treaty of Tordesillas
- (D) Treaty of Nanking

Q2.

In which year did the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) come into force?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1974
- (C) 2002
- (D) 1994

Q3.

In which year did ASEAN and China sign the Declaration on the Code of Conduct of Parties in the South China Sea?

- (A) 2002
- (B) 2012
- (C) 2013
- (D) 2016

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Philippines took its dispute with China over the South China Sea to the Permanent Court of Arbitration.

Reason (R): The Permanent Court of Arbitration has the power to enforce its rulings.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Permanent Court of Arbitration	A. China has exercised de facto control since 1974
II. UNCLOS	B. Established at The Hague in 1899
III. Scarborough Shoal region	C. Came into force in 1994
IV. Paracel Islands	D. Standoff in 2012 gave China de facto control

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the South China Sea:

- I. It is bordered by Taiwan and Brunei, among other countries.
- II. The Luzon Strait connects it with the East China Sea.
- III. UNCTAD estimates that over 21% of global trade passes through it.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Paracel Islands and Scarborough Shoal are correct?

- I. The Paracel Islands are claimed by China, Taiwan and Vietnam.
- II. The Paracel Islands are claimed by Brunei.
- III. The Scarborough Shoal is claimed by the Philippines, China and Taiwan.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q8.

Greater Chinese militarisation of the South China Sea is linked to which broader Chinese initiative?

- (A) Belt and Road land corridor
- (B) String of Pearls
- (C) Digital Silk Road
- (D) Maritime Silk Road

Selection process and straw polls

The United Nations Security Council has held a second round of informal straw polls to help identify a successor to Antonio Guterres, whose second term as Secretary-General is due to end at the close of the year. The selection process begins when the presidents of the General Assembly and the Security Council jointly write to member states, inviting them to put forward candidates. Nominees usually submit a curriculum vitae and a vision statement describing their experience and qualifications. They then take part in interactive dialogues, where they explain their plans for the organisation and answer questions. The straw poll is the next stage. It is an informal and confidential exercise in which Council members show how acceptable each candidate is to them. Because the process runs through successive rounds, weaker candidates can be filtered out over time. Each round gives the Council a clearer picture of which names have broad acceptance among its members, and the process is designed to continue until one candidate has the backing needed. The straw polls are an important stage in narrowing the field, but they are not the final step, since the Council must still formally recommend a candidate before the General Assembly acts.

Q1.

How many UN Member States are invited to nominate candidates?

- (A) 15
- (B) 54
- (C) 100
- (D) 193

Q2.

Which Article of the UN Charter provides for the appointment of the Secretary-General?

- (A) Article 97
- (B) Article 51
- (C) Article 108
- (D) Article 24

Q3.

Assertion (A): A candidate who receives a 'Discourage' from a Permanent Member is likely to advance in the formal vote if at least nine Council members support him or her.

Reason (R): A 'Discourage' indication from a Permanent Member effectively signals that the candidate would face a veto in a formal vote.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Encourage	A. Used by Permanent Members in subsequent rounds
II. Discourage	B. Member has not taken a position
III. No Opinion	C. Member supports or favours the candidate
IV. Distinctively coloured ballots	D. Member indicates opposition to the candidate

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Security Council's straw polls and selection process:

- I. In subsequent straw poll rounds, Permanent Members use distinctively coloured ballots.
- II. A preferred candidate needs at least 9 of 15 votes and no veto from any Permanent Member.
- III. Straw poll results are binding on the General Assembly's final appointment.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Secretary-General's term are correct?

- I. The UN Charter prescribes a fixed five-year term for the Secretary-General.
- II. Established UN practice provides for a five-year term.
- III. Regional rotation is a legally binding provision of the UN Charter.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

How many Permanent Members of the 15-member Security Council hold veto power?

- (A) Five
- (B) Three
- (C) Seven
- (D) Nine

Q8.

How many positions can a member indicate in a straw poll?

- (A) Two
- (B) Four
- (C) Five
- (D) Three

Cauvery dispute history check

The Cauvery water dispute is one of the oldest inter-state water conflicts in India, and its roots lie in agreements made long before independence. The disagreement began between the Madras Presidency and the princely state of Mysore. Madras objected when Mysore planned to expand its irrigation and build new water storage structures on the river. A later arrangement allowed Mysore to construct a dam at a village in the region, and that dam later became a major reservoir. The original agreement was meant to operate for a fixed period, and when it came up for review, it became a major source of contention between the successor states. The upper riparian state wants more water for Bengaluru's drinking water and irrigation, while the lower riparian state wants assured releases to support the agriculture of its delta. Because the states could not settle the matter by agreement, the dispute was taken up under the legal framework available for such conflicts. A tribunal was then formed to decide the sharing of water, and its award was later examined by the Supreme Court. Today, a statutory body works to put the final decision into practice, with the help of a regulation committee. Current releases and new projects such as Mokedatu keep the dispute active in public debate.

Q1.

In which year was the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal constituted?

- (A) 1990
- (B) 2007
- (C) 1974
- (D) 2018

Q2.

The CWDT Award of 2007 allocated a total of how many TMC of Cauvery water?

- (A) 740 TMC
- (B) 404.25 TMC
- (C) 419 TMC
- (D) 284.75 TMC

Q3.

The 1924 agreement allowed Mysore to construct a dam at Kannambadi village, which led to the development of which dam?

- (A) Mettur Dam
- (B) Mokedatu Dam
- (C) Hemavathi Dam
- (D) Krishnaraja Sagar Dam

Q4.

Assertion (A): The 1924 agreement came up for review after 1974.

Reason (R): The Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal was constituted in 1990.

- (A) (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) (b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) (c) A is true but R is false
- (D) (d) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal	A. Dam developed under the 1924 agreement
II. Krishnaraja Sagara	B. Aims to supply drinking water to Bengaluru
III. Mekedatu project	C. Major dam in Tamil Nadu
IV. Mettur Dam	D. Constituted in 1990

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Cauvery water sharing awards:

- I. The 2007 award set aside 14 TMC of Cauvery water for environmental purposes.
- II. The 2018 Supreme Court judgment gave Karnataka a larger share than Tamil Nadu.
- III. The 2007 award gave Puducherry 7 TMC of Cauvery water.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Cauvery dispute:

- I. The 1924 agreement was intended to operate for 50 years.
- II. The Krishnaraja Sagar Dam was developed under the 1892 agreement.
- III. The dispute was brought under Article 262.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Apart from Article 262, under which Central Act was the Cauvery dispute brought?

- (A) River Boards Act, 1956
- (B) Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974
- (C) National Water Policy Act
- (D) Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956

Historical Roots and Current Process

The demand for a separate political or administrative arrangement for the Nepali-speaking Gorkha population of the Darjeeling Hills in West Bengal has a long history. The Gorkhas are people of

Nepali origin, and the term is linked to the historic Gorkha Kingdom of Western Nepal. Political demands for greater autonomy can be traced to the early twentieth century, when the Darjeeling Hillmen's Association petitioned during the Minto-Morley Reforms. Other organisations, including the Gorkha Officers' Association, kept raising demands for greater political autonomy in the years that followed. The Gorkhas also have a distinctive martial tradition, and the British began systematic recruitment of Gorkha soldiers after the Anglo-Nepal War. The movement became far more intense during the 1980s under a new political force. Over time, the movement's objective became clearer in its articulation. More recently, the Ministry of Home Affairs convened a Tripartite Meeting involving the Government of West Bengal and representatives of the Gorkha community. Following that meeting, the Union Government constituted a committee to work out modalities for a Permanent Political Solution. The committee will examine the issue within the Constitutional Framework, including governance arrangements and financial assistance.

Q1.

In 1947, which party submitted a memorandum seeking 'Gorkhasthan' to Jawaharlal Nehru and Liaquat Ali Khan?

- (A) Indian National Congress
- (B) Gorkha National Liberation Front
- (C) Gorkha Officers' Association
- (D) Undivided Communist Party of India

Q2.

Subhas Ghising led which organisation that emerged in 1980 as the principal political force behind the 1980s agitation?

- (A) Gorkha National Liberation Front
- (B) Gorkha Janmukti Morcha
- (C) Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council
- (D) Kurseong Gorkha Library

Q3.

Assertion (A): Over time, the Gorkha movement articulated its objective as achieving statehood within the Indian Union.

Reason (R): Gorkha demands for political autonomy were first raised only during the 1980s agitation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council	A. Led by Subhas Ghising
II. Gorkhaland Territorial Administration	B. Also called Chicken's Neck
III. Siliguri Corridor	C. Created in 2011
IV. Gorkha National Liberation Front	D. Created in 1988

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q5.

In which year were Gorkha demands presented before the Simon Commission?

- (A) 1907
- (B) 1980
- (C) 1947
- (D) 1929

Q6.

Which Gorkha ruler played a central role in the unification of Nepal?

- (A) Prithvi Narayan Shah
- (B) Sonam Wangel Laden La
- (C) Subhas Ghising
- (D) Guru Gorakhnath

Amendment and enforcement MCQs

Parliament has passed the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026. The amendment follows the controversy over the NEET-UG 2024 paper leak, in which alleged leak networks were reported to be operating in Patna (Bihar) and Hazaribagh (Jharkhand). Concern grew after 67 candidates secured full marks, aided by disputed grace marks, which triggered nationwide protests and judicial scrutiny. Earlier, Parliament had enacted the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. It is India's first dedicated central legislation on question-paper leaks, organised cheating and examination-related fraud. The Act covers major examinations conducted by bodies such as the UPSC, SSC, Railway Recruitment Boards, the National Testing Agency and the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection. The 2026 Amendment is aimed at stronger deterrence. It revises the penalties under four categories: individual offences, service providers, organised examination crime and organised crimes. The penalty for each category differs, so the consequence depends on the category of offence. Demands for stronger deterrence and faster legal proceedings also grew as the controversy continued. The amendment also aims to ensure that examination fraud cases do not remain pending for prolonged periods. It introduces time-bound investigation and trial for offences under the Act. The revised penalties apply to offences under the Act, which covers the examinations listed above.

Q1.

Under the 2026 Amendment, what is the revised punishment for individual offences under the Act?

- (A) 3-5 years + fine up to ₹50 lakh
- (B) Life imprisonment
- (C) 1-2 years + fine up to ₹5 lakh
- (D) 5-10 years + fine up to ₹50 lakh

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Organised Examination Crime	A. 8-year ban
II. Service Providers	B. 5-10 years + fine up to ₹50 lakh
III. Individual Offences	C. At least 7 years + ₹10 crore fine
IV. Organised Crimes	D. At least 5 years + ₹5 crore fine

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is India's first dedicated central legislation on question-paper leaks and exam-related fraud.
- II. The 2026 Amendment gives statutory backing to Fast-Track Courts for trying offences under the Act.
- III. Under the amended Act, appeals before High Courts are heard by a single judge within one month.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Under the 2026 Amendment, individual offences attract 5-10 years of punishment.
- II. The 11th Finance Commission first recommended Fast Track Courts in 2010.
- III. Appeals before High Courts under the amended Act are disposed of within 6 months.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q5.

Investigations by which agency, with Supreme Court monitoring, exposed organised cheating syndicates in the NEET-UG 2024 case?

- (A) National Investigation Agency
- (B) Central Bureau of Investigation
- (C) Enforcement Directorate
- (D) Intelligence Bureau

Q6.

Statement I: Under the 2026 Amendment, investigation and trial together are to follow a combined 5-month timeline.

Statement II: Under the 2026 Amendment, the combined timeline for investigation and trial is 6 months.

Which of the statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Q7.

Which Finance Commission first recommended Fast Track Courts in 2000 to expedite the disposal of long-pending criminal cases?

- (A) 9th Finance Commission
- (B) 10th Finance Commission
- (C) 11th Finance Commission
- (D) 12th Finance Commission

1971 Act and 2026 Bill: CLAT practice

India protects its national symbols through specific laws. The Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, is the main law that deals with deliberate insults to the national emblems. It covers the National Flag, the Constitution and the National Anthem, Jana Gana Mana, and it makes certain acts against them punishable. The law describes acts such as burning, defacing or desecrating the flag, and it also covers preventing people from singing the anthem or disturbing a gathering while it is sung. The Act has three main provisions, dealing with the flag and Constitution, the anthem, and repeat offences. The Act was later strengthened so that people who repeat such offences face stricter treatment.

In 2026, the Central Government proposed an amendment to this law in the Rajya Sabha. The Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, aims to extend statutory protection to Vande Mataram, a patriotic song. Under the proposal, intentionally insulting Vande Mataram would become a punishable offence. At present, the Act protects the flag, the Constitution and the anthem, while the amendment seeks to include the National Song, Vande Mataram, within this legal framework. Both the law and the proposed amendment concern national honour.

Q1.

What minimum imprisonment is prescribed under the 1971 Act for a second or subsequent conviction under Section 2 or Section 3?

- (A) No minimum
- (B) 6 months
- (C) 1 year
- (D) 3 years

Q2.

What is the maximum imprisonment prescribed for an offence under Section 2 of the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971?

- (A) 6 months
- (B) 1 year
- (C) 3 years
- (D) 7 years

Q3.

Consider the following statements about Vande Mataram:

- I. It was written on 7 November 1875.
- II. Its first public use was at the Varanasi Congress Session in 1905.
- III. It has six stanzas in total.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) None of the above
- (D) Only two

Q4.

Which section of the 1971 Act prohibits intentionally preventing the singing of the National Anthem?

- (A) Section 2
- (B) Section 3A
- (C) Section 1
- (D) Section 3

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 2	A. Minimum 1 year imprisonment for repeat convictions
II. Section 3	B. Extends protection to Vande Mataram
III. Section 3A	C. Prohibits insult to the National Flag and Constitution
IV. Bill, 2026	D. Prohibits preventing the singing of the National Anthem

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

What punishment has the 2026 Bill proposed for intentionally insulting Vande Mataram?

- (A) Up to 1 year only
- (B) Up to 3 years imprisonment, fine or both
- (C) Life imprisonment
- (D) Fine only, no imprisonment

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Section 2 prohibits intentional insult to or disrespect for the National Flag and Constitution.
- II. Section 3 prohibits intentionally preventing the singing of the National Anthem.
- III. Section 3A was inserted into the original 1971 Act when it was first enacted.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

National Tribunals Commission: MCQ practice

The Lok Sabha has passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill 2026, which proposes to establish a National Tribunals Commission for unified governance of tribunals. The Bill is intended to replace the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021, and to restructure the legal framework that governs tribunal appointments and service conditions. It also re-enacts provisions of the 2021 law that were struck down, and it is drafted in line with the Supreme Court's directions on judicial independence and separation of powers. The Supreme Court has repeatedly examined provisions that gave the Executive excessive control over tribunals, including in *Madras Bar Association v. Union of India*. The proposed Commission would provide a common institutional framework for all tribunals covered under the Bill. Its major functions include selecting tribunal chairpersons and members, reviewing the performance of members, overseeing complaints and disciplinary inquiries, and providing administrative supervision. It will also maintain a national tribunals data grid. For selection, a Search-cum-Selection Committee will recommend candidates for each vacancy. The Commission framework applies to a wide range of bodies, from central and state administrative tribunals to specialised bodies such as the Armed Forces Tribunal and the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission. The Central Government will frame the rules governing service conditions. Reappointment for another term is considered on the basis of past performance.

Q1.

What minimum relevant experience must the Technical Members of the National Tribunals Commission have?

- (A) 15 years
- (B) 20 years
- (C) 25 years
- (D) 30 years

Q2.

Within what time must the Central Government complete the appointment process after receiving an NTC recommendation?

- (A) 1 month
- (B) 3 months
- (C) 6 months
- (D) 1 year

Q3.

Assertion (A): The Search-cum-Selection Committee of the NTC recommends candidates for each vacancy.

Reason (R): The Central Government must complete the appointment process within three months of receiving the recommendation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Age cap for NTC Chairpersons	A. Five years
II. Age cap for NTC Members	B. 70 years
III. Maximum term for NTC Chairpersons and Members	C. 16
IV. Tribunals and authorities covered by the framework	D. 67 years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the National Tribunals Commission:

- I. The Judicial Members must be Chief Justices or Judges of a High Court.
- II. The Chairperson must be a Judge of the Supreme Court or a Chief Justice of a High Court.
- III. Reappointment of members is decided by the Central Government alone, without consulting the Tribunal Chairperson.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the National Tribunals Commission framework:

- I. Chairpersons are capped at 70 years of age.
- II. Members are capped at 70 years of age.
- III. Terms are capped at five years, or the age limit if earlier.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q7.

Which of the following bodies is included among the tribunals covered under the proposed framework?

- (A) Supreme Court of India
- (B) National Green Tribunal
- (C) High Court of Delhi
- (D) Election Commission of India

Q8.

How many Judicial Members does the National Tribunals Commission have, apart from the Chairperson?

- (A) 1
- (B) 3
- (C) 4
- (D) 2

Components, targets and priority basins

India imports a large part of the crude oil and natural gas it uses, and policymakers have long wanted more of this supply to come from within the country. Much of the unexplored potential lies beneath the sea, in deep and far-off waters where drilling is costly and technically demanding. Companies hesitate to commit money to such projects because results can take years to arrive. At the same time, the fields that already produce oil and gas do not stay productive forever. Their output falls every year as the reservoirs age, so new discoveries are needed just to keep production steady.

The Samudra Manthan Scheme is the government's response to this problem. It is built around several linked streams of work. Some streams focus on locating resources and on drilling in difficult waters. Others focus on shared facilities that can move produced oil and gas, on building a domestic base of manufacturing and services, and on developing skills and technology. The plan also sets a clear quantity goal, aiming to add a large volume of reserves and to raise annual domestic output. Taken together, the scheme hopes to reduce risk for investors, strengthen national capability, and make India less reliant on imported energy in the years ahead.

Q1.

Under the Samudra Manthan Scheme, what is the target for adding reserves?

- (A) Over 300 MMTOE
- (B) Over 600 MMTOE
- (C) Over 900 MMTOE
- (D) Over 1200 MMTOE

Q2.

By how much is annual domestic oil and gas production targeted to rise under the scheme?

- (A) From 40 to 60 MMTOE
- (B) From 80 to 100 MMTOE
- (C) From 100 to 120 MMTOE
- (D) From 62 to 80 MMTOE

Q3.

What is the target for expanding India's resource base under the scheme?

- (A) From 1.6 billion to 2.2 billion tonnes of oil equivalent
- (B) From 1 billion to 1.5 billion tonnes of oil equivalent
- (C) From 2 billion to 3 billion tonnes of oil equivalent
- (D) From 0.5 billion to 1 billion tonnes of oil equivalent

Q4.

Assertion (A): The scheme offers government risk-sharing to attract private investment into offshore projects.

Reason (R): Offshore exploration involves high financial and technological risks.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Seismic exploration	A. Accelerated drilling in deepwater and frontier basins
II. Exploratory drilling	B. Shared production and evacuation infrastructure
III. Common infrastructure	C. Integrated oil and gas manufacturing and services zone
IV. Manufacturing & services	D. Acquisition, processing and interpretation of seismic data

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Which of the following statements about the scheme is/are correct?

- I. The implementation period runs up to FY 2030-31.
- II. Government support covers up to 75% of eligible drilling costs.
- III. Krishna-Godavari Basin is among the priority offshore regions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the scheme are correct?

- I. The scheme is classified as a State Sector Scheme.
- II. A deepwater exploratory well can cost approximately \$125-150 million.
- III. Existing oil and gas fields face production declines of around 6-7% annually.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q8.

Which of the following is NOT listed as a priority offshore region under the scheme?

- (A) Krishna-Godavari Basin
- (B) Cauvery Basin
- (C) Mahanadi Basin
- (D) Rann of Kutch Basin

Sarnath: inscription, sites and sermon

Sarnath, a Buddhist site in Uttar Pradesh, has recently been inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List. The inscription was made at a meeting of the World Heritage Committee, and it raised the total number of such sites in India. Sarnath holds a special place in Buddhist history because Gautama Buddha gave his first teaching there after attaining enlightenment at Bodhgaya. The event marks the beginning of the Buddhist monastic community, known as the Sangha, and it is linked with the Noble Eightfold Path. The site was known in earlier times by several names, and it is visited today for its monuments. Visitors see the Chaukhandi, Dhamekh and Dharmarajika stupas, a vihara and the Ashokan Pillar. Many of these structures are linked with episodes from the Buddha's life or with rulers of the past. Sarnath is also counted among the principal Buddhist pilgrimage sites. India has many heritage sites of different kinds, grouped as cultural, natural and mixed. Each category holds its own set of monuments, and together they show how varied the country's heritage is. The process of recognition involves assessment by expert bodies before the final decision is taken by the committee.

Q1.

During which session of the World Heritage Committee was Sarnath inscribed, and in which city was it held?

- (A) 46th session, New Delhi
- (B) 47th session, Riyadh
- (C) 48th session, Busan (Republic of Korea)
- (D) 49th session, Paris

Q2.

After Sarnath's inscription, how many UNESCO World Heritage Sites does India have in total?

- (A) 40
- (B) 48
- (C) 45
- (D) 42

Q3.

What is the name of the event when Gautama Buddha gave his first sermon at Sarnath?

- (A) Dharmachakra Pravartana
- (B) Mahaparinirvana
- (C) Sambodhi
- (D) Nirvana Chakra

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Ashokan Pillar at Sarnath carries a Lion Capital.

Reason (R): The Lion Capital is India's National Emblem.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chaukhandi Stupa	A. Buddha's first sermon
II. Dhamekh Stupa	B. Buddha's rainy-season retreat
III. Dharmarajika Stupa	C. Meeting of Buddha and his first five disciples
IV. Mulagandhakuti Vihara	D. Emperor Ashoka and Buddha's relics

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Sarnath:

- I. Sarnath is one of the four principal Buddhist pilgrimage sites.
- II. The Chaukhandi Stupa marks the site of Buddha's first sermon.
- III. The Dharmarajika Stupa is traditionally associated with Emperor Ashoka and Buddha's relics.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Dholavira is the only Indus Valley Civilization site from India on the World Heritage List.
- II. Khangchendzonga National Park is India's mixed heritage site.
- III. The Mulagandhakuti Vihara marks the site of Buddha's first sermon.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Which of the following is NOT an ancient name for Sarnath?

- (A) Rishipatana
- (B) Ishipatana
- (C) Mrigadava
- (D) Kushinagar

UNCCD and COP17 Recall

The 17th round of talks under the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification recently concluded in Ulaanbaatar, the capital of Mongolia. The meeting coincided with a United Nations

observance that draws attention to pastoral communities and the management of rangelands, which are grasslands and open lands used for grazing. The emphasis on pastoral communities reflects how directly their livelihoods depend on the condition of the land. Land degradation was a central concern. It is described as a serious threat to ecosystems, farming, the availability of water and the economic stability of many regions. The crisis affects a large share of the world's land, and delegates argued that restoring whole landscapes is more effective than scattered, isolated projects. Mongolia used the platform to explain the severity of its own problem, and it has a national campaign to plant trees over the coming years. Several countries also promoted nature-based solutions and ecosystem restoration as part of national development planning. The convention itself is a legally binding framework dealing with desertification, land degradation and drought, and its work connects closely with climate and biodiversity agreements. Its broader aim is sustainable land management, so that land continues to support people and nature.

Q1.

How many of the following statements about the UNCCD and COP17 are correct?

- I. The Convention came into force in December 1996.
 - II. Its core objective includes achieving Land Degradation Neutrality by 2030.
 - III. India is not a Party to the Convention.
 - IV. The theme of COP17 was 'Land for Life'.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All four

Q2.

Consider the following statements about the UNCCD:

- I. The Convention is one of three Rio Conventions.
- II. Egypt will host UNCCD COP 18 in Sharm El-Sheikh in 2028.
- III. India is not a Party to the Convention.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

Read the assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): Mongolia's 'Billion Trees' campaign aims to plant 1 billion trees by 2030.

Reason (R): Land degradation is a major threat to ecosystems, agriculture, water availability and economic stability.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN)	A. One of three Rio Conventions
II. UNCCD membership	B. Land resources remain stable or improve
III. UNCCD as one of the Rio Conventions	C. Adopted on 17 June 1994 (World Day to Combat Desertification)
IV. UNCCD adoption date	D. 197 Parties, including 196 countries and the EU

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q5.

Approximately what percentage of the world's land surface is affected by the land degradation crisis?

- (A) 20%
- (B) 30%
- (C) 60%
- (D) 40%

Q6.

Approximately what percentage of Mongolia's territory is affected by land degradation?

- (A) 45%
- (B) 60%
- (C) 77%
- (D) 90%

Q7.

Which country will host UNCCD COP 18 in 2028?

- (A) Mongolia
- (B) India
- (C) Egypt
- (D) Saudi Arabia

Q8.

Which of the following is the principal decision-making body of the UNCCD?

- (A) Conference of the Parties
- (B) Business4Land Initiative
- (C) Drought Resilience Investment Facility
- (D) Riyadh Global Drought Resilience Partnership

Global Tiger Day MCQ set

Wild tigers live in a number of countries across Asia, and Global Tiger Day is an occasion to focus attention on their survival. Governments and conservation groups treat the animal as a shared responsibility, because a tiger that roams across borders cannot be protected by one country alone. The international effort is organised around the countries where wild tigers still live, which are called Tiger Range Countries. These nations meet in summits and sign common documents that describe their aims. The programmes described for this region cover habitat restoration, measures against poaching and cooperation with local communities who live close to forests. A central idea in recent observances is coexistence, meaning that people and tigers should be able to share the same landscape. The campaign also stresses that solutions must be scaled up so that they reach

many forests, not only a few protected areas. In India, the tiger is the national animal, and the country has a legal framework that governs how tiger reserves are created and protected. Public awareness is therefore as important as government action, since many tiger habitats are shared with local communities. Together, these efforts show that the future of the tiger depends on policy, science and the daily choices of people who share its habitat.

Q1.

On which date is Global Tiger Day observed annually?

- (A) 22 July
- (B) 5 August
- (C) 29 July
- (D) 15 September

Q2.

Global Tiger Day was established at which summit?

- (A) 2010 St. Petersburg Tiger Summit, Russia
- (B) 2005 Bangkok Wildlife Summit
- (C) 2015 Delhi Tiger Conference
- (D) 2019 Kathmandu Tiger Forum

Q3.

How many Tiger Range Countries adopted the St. Petersburg Declaration?

- (A) 8
- (B) 10
- (C) 12
- (D) 13

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Target year of the TX2 goal	A. 1973
II. Year Global Tiger Day was celebrated to bolster international efforts	B. 2022
III. International Big Cat Alliance launched	C. 2010
IV. Jim Corbett, first Tiger Reserve set up	D. 2023

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Global Tiger Day was established at the 2010 St. Petersburg Tiger Summit.
- II. Twelve Tiger Range Countries adopted the St. Petersburg Declaration.
- III. The TX2 motto represents the goal of doubling the global tiger population by 2022.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. IUCN observes Global Tiger Day.
 - II. The TX2 goal aimed to triple the tiger population by 2025.
 - III. Thirteen Tiger Range Countries adopted the St. Petersburg Declaration.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None of the above

Q7.

Which of these is named among the Tiger Range Countries in the booklet?

- (A) Brazil
- (B) Kenya
- (C) Vietnam
- (D) Canada

Glaw Lake and Ramsar Basics

Glaw Lake, a lake in the Eastern Himalayas, has recently gained recognition as a wetland of global importance. It lies in Arunachal Pradesh, and its waters are fresh rather than salty. The lake sits within a protected area. The recognition came under the Ramsar Convention, the intergovernmental treaty on wetlands. It is the only international treaty that addresses one specific ecosystem. Under this treaty, wetlands of international importance are declared as Ramsar sites. The term wetland is broad. It describes any area of land covered by water, whether that water is salt, fresh or somewhere in between, and whether it is present seasonally or permanently. Wetland types include rivers, swamps, wet grasslands, peatlands, deltas and tidal flats, as well as mangroves and coral reefs. The treaty has been in force for decades and has many member states. Glaw Lake's recognition is an example of a wider expansion of India's protected wetlands network. India has steadily added sites to its Ramsar network over the years. India also runs a National Wetland Conservation Program, implemented through state authorities. Government schemes also support this work. One scheme focuses on the optimal use of wetlands, and its aims include enhancing biodiversity, carbon stock and income for local communities. Another focus is moving from high-volume tourism to nature tourism at ecologically sensitive wetlands.

Q1.

Glaw Lake is India's which Ramsar Site, by number?

- (A) 75th
- (B) 88th
- (C) 101st
- (D) 110th

Q2.

In which protected area is Glaw Lake situated?

- (A) Kamlang Tiger Reserve and Wildlife Sanctuary
- (B) Namdapha National Park
- (C) Pakke Tiger Reserve
- (D) Mouling National Park

Q3.

Assertion (A): Glaw Lake is a freshwater wetland in the Eastern Himalayas.

Reason (R): Ramsar wetlands are found only in freshwater lakes and rivers.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Montreux Record	A. Notified in 2017
II. Wetland City Accreditation Program	B. Joint effort of Ministry of Tourism and MoEFCC
III. Amrit Dharohar Capacity Building Scheme	C. Validity of 6 years
IV. Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules	D. Launched in 1990

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Glaw Lake:

- I. It is a pristine freshwater lake.
- II. It lies in the Eastern Himalayas region.
- III. It is a coastal wetland of the salt-water type.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Montreux Record are correct?

- (a) It was launched in 1990.
 - (b) It identifies Ramsar sites that need priority conservation attention.
 - (c) Chilka Lake is currently listed in it.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) None
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) Only three

Q7.

Which Indian state has the maximum number of Ramsar sites?

- (A) Rajasthan
- (B) Tamil Nadu
- (C) West Bengal
- (D) Odisha

Glasgow 2026 at a glance: CLAT-style MCQs

The 2026 edition was staged in Glasgow and brought together athletes from the nations and territories of the Commonwealth. The Games are organised by the Commonwealth Games Federation, and the event has a long history that began with a sporting competition held in London in 1911. Glasgow had hosted the event once before, in 2014, so the city has welcomed the Games previously. The programme for 2026 covered a wide range of disciplines, including athletics, swimming, cycling, weightlifting, boxing and judo. Teams from many countries took part, although not every nation entered every discipline. India's contingent included para athletes, and its medal count was reported at the close of the event. Indian women boxers were among the standout performers of the event, and several of them won gold medals. At the closing ceremony, India's flag

was carried by boxer Jaismine Lamboria, who had won a gold medal in the women's 57 kg category. Medal tallies are widely reported, and they are a common way to compare how countries performed across the event.

Q1.

Read the assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): The 23rd Commonwealth Games were held in Glasgow, Scotland.

Reason (R): Neeraj Chopra won silver in the men's javelin throw at Glasgow 2026.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Which city will host the 2030 Commonwealth Games?

- (A) Ahmedabad
- (B) New Delhi
- (C) Glasgow
- (D) Edinburgh

Q3.

How many of the following statements about Glasgow 2026 are correct?

- A. The Games were held in Scotland.
 - B. India fielded a netball team.
 - C. Judo was one of the sports featured.
 - D. Cricket was one of the sports featured.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mascot of Glasgow 2026	A. 74
II. Nations and territories	B. 10
III. Sports featured at Glasgow 2026	C. Ahmedabad
IV. Host of the 2030 Commonwealth Games	D. Finnie

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

How many nations and territories took part in Glasgow 2026?

- (A) 74
- (B) 54
- (C) 65
- (D) 82

Q6.

How many sports were featured at Glasgow 2026?

- (A) 8
- (B) 12
- (C) 10
- (D) 19

Q7.

What is the name of the mascot of Glasgow 2026?

- (A) Clyde
- (B) Finnie
- (C) Brodie
- (D) Hamish

Q8.

Consider the following statements about Glasgow 2026:

- I. The Games featured 10 sports.
- II. India fielded teams in 3x3 Basketball and Netball.
- III. The mascot Finnie was inspired by Scotland's National Animal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Flag, freedom and the navy

The national flag of India took shape over several decades of the freedom struggle. Pingali Venkayya, a freedom fighter from Andhra Pradesh, worked on flag designs and is remembered for his role in the Indian Tricolour. At the 1921 session of the Indian National Congress held at Vijayawada, he presented a khadi flag design to Mahatma Gandhi. His first design had red and green bands, with a charkha at the centre, representing the two major communities. On Gandhi's suggestion, a white band was added to stand for peace, while the charkha was kept as a symbol of self-reliance. In 1931, the Congress formally adopted a modified tricolour, which became the precursor of the present flag. The Constituent Assembly adopted the present National Flag on 22 July 1947, and it became the national flag of independent India on 15 August 1947.

The freedom movement also reached the armed forces. In 1946, Indian naval ratings rose against British authorities in several port cities, demanding better food, pay comparable with the Royal Navy, and an end to the use of Indian personnel for British imperial expansion. The uprising drew support from workers, students and civilians. Its anti-colonial mood was shaped in part by the legacy of the Indian National Army trials.

Symbols and protests of this period show how closely ideas of unity, peace and self-reliance were linked with the struggle for independence.

Q1.

On which date did the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of 1946 begin at HMIS Talwar in Bombay?

- (A) 15 August 1947
- (B) 22 July 1947
- (C) 18 February 1946
- (D) 2 August 1876

Q2.

Which Article of the Constitution mandates respect for the national flag and anthem?

- (A) Article 51A(a)
- (B) Article 19(1)(c)
- (C) Article 43B
- (D) Part IXB

Q3.

How many spokes does the Ashoka Chakra on the national flag have?

- (A) 12
- (B) 16
- (C) 21
- (D) 24

Q4.

Assertion (A): The white band on the national flag represents peace and truth.

Reason (R): Flag or anthem offences lead to a 6-year election ban under the National Honour Act.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ashoka Chakra	A. Fertility and growth
II. Green colour on the flag	B. Governs display and use of the flag
III. First flag hoisted in Kolkata (1907)	C. Navy blue wheel with 24 spokes
IV. Flag Code of India	D. Red, yellow and green stripes with Vande Mataram

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Venkayya met Mahatma Gandhi during the 2nd Boer War (1899-1902).
- II. Venkayya authored The Mother of Diamonds in 1921.
- III. All India Radio Vijayawada was renamed in his honour in 2015.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of 1946:

- I. It spread to Karachi, Visakhapatnam, Jamnagar and Kolkata.
- II. Rebels organised themselves under a Naval Strike Committee.
- III. One of its demands was the withdrawal of British Indian troops from Indonesia.
- IV. It began at HMIS Talwar in Karachi.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q8.

The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny of 1946 was partly shaped by the legacy of the INA trials and which leader?

- (A) Mahatma Gandhi
- (B) Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis
- (C) Pingali Venkayya
- (D) Subhas Chandra Bose

Dirac Medal: award check

The Dirac Medal is an annual award that honours the legacy of the renowned physicist Paul Dirac. Dirac is remembered as one of the founders of modern quantum mechanics, and the medal carries his name. In 2026, the medal was awarded to the physicist Deepak Dhar, who shared the honour with three other physicists. The recognition was given for pioneering work in statistical mechanics, the field in which their research lies. Each recipient of the award receives a medal, which marks the honour in a tangible form. The award is given every year, and the 2026 medal is the latest of these presentations. Readers preparing for competitive examinations should keep the winners, the field of the work and the namesake of the award together while revising. Knowing the namesake links the medal to the history of quantum mechanics, and knowing the field helps in identifying the 2026 work. This item appears in the AILET Corner of the August 2026 current affairs section. Each of the details above is part of the same award, so revising them together helps in keeping the item clear in memory.

Q1.

In which year was the Dirac Medal instituted?

- (A) 1933
- (B) 1985
- (C) 1995
- (D) 2026

Q2.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Dirac Medal was instituted in 1985.
 - II. The medal is presented by the International Centre for Theoretical Physics.
 - III. The medal is named after Erwin Schrödinger.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Year the Dirac Medal was instituted	A. International Centre for Theoretical Physics
II. Cash prize per recipient	B. 1933
III. Body that presents the medal	C. 1985
IV. Year Dirac received the Nobel Prize	D. US\$5,000

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q4.

Deepak Dhar, the 2026 recipient, is a physicist from which country?

- (A) United States
- (B) India
- (C) Germany
- (D) Israel

Q5.

Which international body presents the Dirac Medal?

- (A) International Centre for Theoretical Physics
- (B) International Atomic Energy Agency
- (C) Royal Society of London
- (D) Nobel Foundation

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Paul Dirac:

- I. Dirac received the 1933 Nobel Prize in Physics.
- II. Dirac shared the 1933 Nobel Prize with Erwin Schrödinger.
- III. Dirac shared the 2026 Dirac Medal with Deepak Dhar.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Which of the following did NOT share the 2026 Dirac Medal?

- (A) Bernard Derrida
- (B) Haim Sompolinsky
- (C) Deepak Dhar
- (D) Erwin Schrödinger

Type-in-the-answer passages

Refugee and trafficking treaties

International law on refugees and trafficking is built from several separate agreements rather than one document. Some agreements focus on organised crime and on protecting people, especially women and children, from being exploited. Others define who counts as a refugee, what rights that person should have, and why a refugee must not be sent back to a place of danger. Still other treaties cover civil and political rights, and they include protections against cruel treatment when a

person is returned to their home country. The framework also reaches children, whose welfare in conflict and displacement is addressed by a separate treaty on their rights. The Global Compact on Refugees (2018) offers a framework to support refugees and host countries. The Global Refugee Forum is held every four years to address challenges faced by refugees and host communities. India is not a signatory to the 1951 Refugee Convention and 1967 Protocol. Each agreement was written for a different purpose, so their scope and obligations vary. Overall, the system combines criminal law, human rights and humanitarian commitments into one broad structure.

Q1.

In which year was the Palermo Protocol adopted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the United Nations Relief and Works Agency established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Convention on the Rights of the Child adopted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Global Compact on Refugees framework introduced? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How often is the Global Refugee Forum held? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country, named in the booklet, is not a signatory to the 1951 Refugee Convention or the 1967 Protocol?

Answer: _____

Antelope Reef Facts

Antelope Reef has moved to the centre of debate over military activity in the South China Sea. The reef lies in a group of islands where several states have competing claims, and the area is among the busiest maritime zones in the world. Shipping that carries a large share of global trade moves through these waters every year, so any change in the region draws close attention from neighbouring countries and from trading nations far away.

Reports describe construction work that has transformed the reef, with reclaimed land, a wharf and other port facilities built alongside. Such facilities are often linked to naval use, but the government that controls the site has described its work differently and has pointed to scientific research. The reef could support larger operations over time.

Security experts have discussed what such a base could mean for the wider balance of power. A secure base for large submarines would be valuable to any navy, and a well-equipped reef could also support surveillance and patrols. Neighbouring countries have reason for concern, since military facilities on disputed features could change how the sea is used and who controls its routes.

Questions for the region now include how these developments fit into a broader plan to strengthen maritime influence, and whether other states will respond with their own installations.

Q1.

In which disputed island group is Antelope Reef located? (name the group)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the approximate length of the wharf built at Antelope Reef? (in metres)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the approximate size of the artificial island China has reclaimed at Antelope Reef? (in km)

Answer: _____

Q4.

China says the Antelope Reef development serves which kind of purposes? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What strategic term describes a protected maritime zone for China's nuclear-powered submarines that Antelope Reef could create? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Roughly how long is the straight coastline at Antelope Reef that is potentially suitable for an airstrip or runway? (in km)

Answer: _____

Term, appointment and rotation

The selection of the UN Secretary-General combines written rules with long-standing custom. The founding Charter explains how the post is filled, but it does not set a limit on how long the holder may serve. Over time, a standard length of office has developed through practice, and the holder is normally allowed to seek a further term, although this rests on custom rather than written rules. The Security Council plays the decisive role in the process. The Council has fifteen members, and each one holds a single vote, so its recommendation reflects collective judgment rather than the preference of one state. When the Council settles on a candidate, its recommendation passes to the wider membership of the United Nations, which makes the formal appointment. Even though that wider body could decide by a simple majority, appointments have usually been made without a vote, through agreement or general approval. The choice is also shaped by an unwritten expectation that the post should move between different parts of the world. This expectation is meant to give every region a fair chance of representation at the top of the organisation. Candidates are expected to present their experience and their vision for the organisation before member states. The practice reflects an effort to balance representation across the world.

Q1.

What is the conventional length, in years, of a Secretary-General's term under established UN practice? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many times is a Secretary-General's term conventionally renewable? (answer in digits)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Article of the UN Charter is the Secretary-General appointed on the Council's recommendation? (answer as the article number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which informal principle, aimed at geographical representation, has traditionally guided the choice of Secretary-General?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many broad regional groupings are involved in the regional rotation principle? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Is regional rotation a legally binding provision of the UN Charter? (answer yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which UN body formally appoints the Secretary-General? (name the body)

Answer: _____

CWMA quick recall

Implementing a river water award requires a permanent institution, and for the Cauvery the government set up a dedicated authority. The body was created together with a regulation committee, so that management and monitoring work could be divided. Its legal character is that of a statutory and quasi-judicial body, which means it has a legal basis in a central law on inter-state river disputes. Its main job is to give effect to the modified tribunal award, which the country's highest court had upheld. The authority is headed by a senior official who serves for a fixed term, and it includes full-time and part-time members. Members come from the basin states and a union territory as well as from the central government, so that all stakeholders have a voice in decisions. The authority's functions include ensuring that water is released as directed, which makes its work closely watched by the states. Its work has come into sharp focus recently, after it endorsed an order on water releases from one state to another. Understanding its composition and legal status helps explain how the Cauvery dispute is managed today. Because its decisions affect farmers and cities alike, the authority plays a central role in the dispute.

Q1.

In which year was the Cauvery Water Management Authority established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many years does the Chairperson of the Authority serve? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Section of the Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956 is the Authority notified?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city is the Authority's headquarters located?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many full-time members does the Authority have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many part-time members represent the basin states and UT on the Authority? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Union Ministry does the Authority's headquarters function?

Answer: _____

Institutions and Challenges Recall

Successive arrangements have tried to give the Darjeeling hill region a measure of self-governance since the agitation of the 1980s. The first such body was a hill council set up after that agitation to provide greater autonomy to the region. Its effectiveness, however, was constrained by limited legislative authority, inadequate financial autonomy and dependence on the state government. A later, more empowered autonomous arrangement was created, with greater administrative, executive and financial responsibilities than the council. Demands for a fuller political solution have nevertheless continued. Opposition in parts of the state to any further territorial division is based on concerns about territorial integrity, economic interests and administrative cohesion. The Darjeeling region also occupies a sensitive geographical position, close to three neighbouring countries. Its corridor is the main land link between mainland India and the Northeast, so prolonged instability there could have wider security implications. Gorkha politics is itself divided among several organisations and groups, which makes a common position difficult. The regional economy depends on tea, tourism and related activities, which face structural and seasonal challenges.

Q1.

In which year was the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council established? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Gorkhaland Territorial Administration established? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who heads the committee constituted by the Union Government to work out a 'Permanent Political Solution'? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which corridor, also called Chicken's Neck, is located in the Darjeeling region? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Besides the Gorkha National Liberation Front, which other Gorkha political group is named as part of the fragmented political representation? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many Gorkha communities are proposed for a roadmap to Scheduled Tribe status? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Speedy trial TITA

Long pendency of criminal cases is a concern that the amendment addresses for examination offences. Fast-Track Courts are meant to speed up trials of cases that have remained pending for long periods. The amended law now gives them statutory backing to try offences under the Act. The Supreme Court has treated speedy trial as a fundamental right under Article 21, and it has held that access to justice is a fundamental right under Articles 14 and 21. It has also held that no fixed time limit can be prescribed for concluding criminal trials, as that is neither feasible nor judicially permissible. The government has also set up a high-powered task force for strategic policy reforms. Initial Fast-Track Courts have been announced in High Courts where NEET-related cases are pending. Fast-Track Special Courts were set up under a Centrally Sponsored Scheme for rape and offences under the POCSO Act. The amendment also aims to ensure that examination fraud cases do not remain pending for prolonged periods. It introduces time-bound investigation and trial, and appeals before High Courts are to be heard by a two-judge Division Bench. Special Task Force powers under the Act are particularly relevant to inter-state paper-leak networks and organised criminal syndicates. The amended provisions are set out alongside the earlier law in a comparison table.

Q1.

In which year did the 11th Finance Commission first recommend Fast Track Courts to expedite the disposal of long-pending criminal cases?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In how many High Courts were initial Fast-Track Courts announced for pending NEET-related cases? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the combined timeline for investigation and trial under the amendment? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Supreme Court judgment of 2002 held that no fixed time limit can be prescribed for concluding criminal trials? Give the first-named party's name.

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year were Fast-Track Special Courts set up under a Centrally Sponsored Scheme for rape and POCSO Act offences?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Within how many months must appeals before High Courts under the amended Act be disposed of? (in months)

Answer: _____

Vande Mataram history: recall

Vande Mataram is a patriotic song written by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay. It was composed as a response to British promotion of 'God Save the King', and it first appeared in a magazine in 1875. Later, the song became part of a novel in which warrior-monks sing it. The song praises Mother India through the image of a goddess, and its verses are divided into stanzas, with some verses in Sanskrit and the rest in Bengali.

After the Partition of Bengal in 1905, the song became closely linked with the national struggle. It was sung in public for the first time at Town Hall in Calcutta, and it soon became the customary opening song at a Congress session. An Indian flag bearing its words was also unfurled in Europe. Several tunes were composed for the song over the years, and it was sung at many national events.

Later, the national leadership had to decide how much of the song should be used at gatherings. After independence, the song was declared the National Song of India and was to be honoured equally with the National Anthem. The Constitution does not explicitly recognise a National Song. Its popularity and its official status therefore developed over several decades.

Q1.

In which year was Vande Mataram published in the novel Anandamath? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many stanzas does Vande Mataram have in total? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who sang Vande Mataram at the 1896 INC Session? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did Bhikaji Cama unfurl an Indian flag inscribed with Vande Mataram at Stuttgart? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who sang Vande Mataram as the customary opening song at the 1905 Varanasi Congress Session? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

As per the 1937 Congress Working Committee decision, how many stanzas were to be used for national gatherings? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

After the Partition of Bengal, which movement did Vande Mataram become the rallying cry of? (give the name of the movement)

Answer: _____

National Green Tribunal: typed answer practice

The National Green Tribunal is a statutory body created under an Act of Parliament to deal with environmental disputes. Its objective is to provide relief and compensation for environmental damage, and its work rests on the polluter pays principle and the goal of sustainable development. India is one of the few countries to have set up a specialised environmental tribunal, and the NGT is the body through which such cases are heard. The Tribunal is headed by a Chairperson who is either a retired Supreme Court judge or a former Chief Justice of a High Court. Its members are of two kinds, judicial members and expert members, and the Central Government decides their exact number. The Tribunal has a principal place of sitting and also holds sittings at regional benches in several other cities. The NGT hears civil cases arising under a set of environmental laws, and it has original jurisdiction over civil cases with substantial environmental questions. It is guided by the

principles of natural justice and is not bound by the Code of Civil Procedure. Its decisions can be executed as a decree of a civil court. Appeals against its orders can be taken to the Supreme Court, and the Tribunal must dispose of appeals within a fixed period from the date they are filed. Certain statutes, including a wildlife law and a forest rights law, are excluded from its jurisdiction.

Q1.

In which year was the statutory body National Green Tribunal established under the NGT Act? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the principal place of sitting of the National Green Tribunal? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many regional benches does the National Green Tribunal have, apart from its principal place of sitting? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Within how many months must the NGT dispose of appeals from the date of their filing? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Within how many days can an appeal be filed against an NGT decision in the Supreme Court? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Forest Rights Act enacted, the law that the NGT excludes from its jurisdiction? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The Central Government appoints the NGT Chairperson in consultation with which authority? (name the authority)

Answer: _____

Outlay and risk-sharing

Offshore hydrocarbon exploration needs large sums of public money before any oil or gas reaches the market. Surveys of the seabed, test drilling in deep water and the construction of shared facilities all require heavy spending. The government has therefore set aside a fixed amount for the scheme for a defined period. The money is divided among several heads, covering drilling, data collection, common infrastructure and manufacturing zones. Some of these heads are large and others are small, reflecting their different roles.

The government has also chosen to share part of the cost of drilling with companies that take part. This is meant to lower the financial risk that makes private firms hesitant about offshore work. The sharing applies only to eligible drilling costs. Officials expect that the combination of public allocations and shared risk will encourage firms to commit capital and bring technology to difficult frontier areas. The scheme's funding is therefore a central feature of its design.

Q1.

What is the total outlay approved for the scheme? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the allocation for Common Offshore Infrastructure Hubs? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the allocation for Oil & Gas Manufacturing and Services Zones? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Up to what percentage of eligible drilling costs does the government support under the risk-sharing mechanism? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many deepwater exploratory wells are included in the scheme's financial allocation? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Up to which financial year is the scheme's implementation period? (give the year range)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the approximate annual natural production decline rate of existing oil and gas fields? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Buddha's life and Buddhist teachings

Gautama Buddha was born as Siddhartha in a noble family near Kapilavastu, close to Lumbini in present-day Nepal. His father was an elected ruler, and his mother came from a royal dynasty of Kosala. Siddhartha left his home in a famous departure and later attained enlightenment, after which people began to call him the Buddha. He spent the rest of his life teaching, and his first sermon was delivered at Sarnath. Buddhism, which developed on the basis of his teachings in the sixth century BC, emphasises the attainment of enlightenment and recommends following a middle path between extremes. Its followers reject the authority of the Vedas and the idea of a permanent soul, which sets Buddhism apart from some other traditions. After the Buddha passed away, his teachings were recited and organised at a series of gatherings known as councils. The first council grouped the teachings into collections, which were later written down. Buddhist texts preserve these teachings in several collections, including the main discourses and the rules of conduct for monks and nuns. The core of his message concerns suffering, its causes, its ending and the path that leads to that ending, and this remains central to the faith. Each of these ideas connects with the others, and together they form the basis of the religion.

Q1.

In which year BC was Siddhartha, later Gautama Buddha, born? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year BC did Buddha die at Kushinagara? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What term did Buddha use to refer to himself, meaning one who has thus come or gone?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Into how many Pitakas were Buddha's teachings divided at the First Buddhist Council? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many parts does the Atthanga Magga, the path to end suffering, have? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Noble Truth states that suffering could be ended? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who chaired the First Buddhist Council? (name)

Answer: _____

Drought Policy Recall

Drought is one of the harder environmental problems to manage. For a long time, the usual response has been relief once the harm is done. A newer approach asks governments to look at how exposed they are before the damage occurs. To support this, a comprehensive technical instrument was introduced to help countries judge how prepared they are for drought. It draws on modern data-analysis tools, studies the vulnerability of communities and maps the risks they face. Money is the other side of the problem. Public funds can play a catalytic role, bringing in private and institutional investors to finance water security, climate-resilient farming and land restoration. A fresh pool of finance announced at the recent conference was meant for restoring land and building drought resilience in vulnerable countries. Discussions about a binding global instrument for drought form part of the wider debate. Land and water are closely linked. Overall, drought is best understood as a problem of preparation and investment, not only of emergency response.

Q1.

Along with UNCCD, which country launched the Drought Resilience Investment Facility (DRIF)? (answer in one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What does DRIF use public finance to do in order to attract private and institutional capital? (answer in one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of the new instrument introduced to assess national preparedness against drought?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Drought management is to shift from post-disaster relief towards which kind of planning? (answer in one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How much new and pipeline funding was announced for land restoration and drought resilience in vulnerable countries? (in USD billion)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Did countries reach consensus on a legally binding global agreement on drought at COP17? (yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q7.

From which COP onwards will drought receive a standalone agenda item? (give the COP number)

Answer: _____

Tiger reserves TITA set

In India, these areas are created under a national programme that gives them legal backing and dedicated management. Any change to a reserve's boundaries needs careful approval, because the rules are meant to protect the animals within them. Officials therefore treat reserve notification as a formal process, not a routine administrative step. Tiger reserves vary greatly in size, from Bor (Maharashtra), the smallest, to Nagarjunsagar Srisailem, the largest. Their tiger numbers are estimated through a periodic count carried out by official agencies with the help of research institutes. Counting takes place in fixed cycles, so that results from different years can be compared. Some states have many reserves while others have only a few. Software-based monitoring systems help managers track conditions in these reserves and respond to threats. The scale of this work is large, and even small changes in reserve boundaries can affect many animals. Together, these features explain why tiger reserves remain central to the country's conservation strategy.

Q1.

How many tiger reserves does India currently have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which state has the largest number of tiger reserves in India? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which tiger reserve has the highest tiger abundance in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which is the largest tiger reserve in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was India's tiger population in the 2022 figure? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was Project Tiger launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which is the smallest tiger reserve in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Wetland Policy Tools

Protecting wetlands in India involves policy as well as science, and several central initiatives work through states and cities. One is a capacity building scheme run jointly by two ministries. Its aim is

to encourage the optimal use of wetlands while enhancing biodiversity, carbon stock and eco-tourism. The scheme also seeks to generate income for local communities. Local communities are among the intended beneficiaries of the scheme. A second measure is the National Wetland Conservation Program, which is carried out through State Wetland Authorities. Later, a regulatory framework for wetlands was notified under a major environmental law. This framework decentralises wetland management and provides for State or Union Territory Wetlands Authorities. Cities can also be recognised for wetland care. The Wetland City Accreditation Program is part of the Ramsar Convention. The Wetland City Accreditation Program promotes the conservation and wise use of urban and peri-urban wetlands. Accreditation is granted only to cities that satisfy all of the programme's international criteria. Protection is also linked with tourism. The government has announced a Nature-Culture Tourism Corridor in Uttar Pradesh, to be developed between two places. Mapping supports these efforts too. A national atlas of wetland decadal change, prepared by a national agency, tracks how wetlands have changed over time. Taken together, these steps reflect a move toward careful use of sensitive wetlands.

Q1.

What is the validity period of Wetland City accreditation? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Wetland City Accreditation Program approved? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from MoEFCC, which ministry jointly runs the Amrit Dharohar Capacity Building Scheme?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year were the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules notified? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which agency prepared the National Wetland Decadal Change Atlas? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from Ayodhya, which place in Uttar Pradesh is linked by the Nature-Culture Tourism Corridor?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the Amrit Dharohar scheme, tourism is to shift from high-volume tourism to what type of tourism? (three words)

Answer: _____

History of the Games: short answers

The idea of a sporting contest across the Commonwealth is older than the Games themselves. It can be traced to an event held in London in 1911, which formed part of a Festival of Empire organised during the coronation celebrations of King George V. The first edition of the Games was held in 1930 in a Canadian city, and the concept is credited to a sportswriter from the same country. The event was generally held once every four years, although the editions scheduled for 1942 and 1946 did not take place.

Over the decades the event has carried several different titles, and its name has changed more

than once. Today the Games are organised by the Commonwealth Games Federation. India has hosted the Games, and its best performance at the Games, with 101 medals, came at that edition.

A centenary edition of the Games is planned for India in a future year, which will mark one hundred years since the first Games. India's first participation came decades before it hosted the Games, showing a long link with the event. The Games are a multi-sport event in which athletes from many nations compete for medals across a range of sports.

Q1.

In which year was the event officially renamed the Commonwealth Games? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the first edition of the Games held in 1930? (city name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the original name of the Games when they were first held in 1930? (name of the event)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Canadian sportswriter is credited with the concept of the Games? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which event did Canadian athlete Gordon Smallacombe win the first gold medal in the history of the Games?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did India host the Commonwealth Games? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did India first participate in the Commonwealth Games? (year)

Answer: _____

Wildlife, index and energy

India's environment and energy policies in 2026 covered wildlife, waste and clean power. India observed World Elephant Day on 12 August, when new initiatives were announced for elephant conservation, including a regional action plan for southern states and a model conservation plan for the Nilgiri Elephant Reserve. Elephants are the largest land animals on Earth, and their conservation depends on reducing conflict with people. Scientists and officials use population studies and monitoring programmes to plan protection of the animals and their migratory routes. Lions also drew attention through Project Lion, which marked a rise in the Asiatic lion population and used software for individual identification of the animals.

On the environment front, India remained among the lowest-performing countries in the Environmental Performance Index, a biennial assessment of 177 countries. The index tracks environmental health, ecosystem vitality and climate change as its main policy objectives. Its air quality and biodiversity ranks were among the weakest, though climate change and sanitation showed some improvement.

For energy, the Cabinet approved a scheme to expand floating solar power linked with energy

storage, to strengthen grid stability. The floating solar projects are a central sector scheme targeting 5,000 MW of capacity. A separate scheme, GOBARdhan, aims to convert organic waste into compressed biogas and bio-slurry. Together, these measures show how waste management and clean energy are being linked with the country's environmental goals.

Q1.

What was the estimated wild elephant population of India in the 2021-25 synchronous estimation? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What rank did India get among 177 countries in the Environmental Performance Index 2026? (rank number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the Asiatic lion population in 2025? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country topped the Environmental Performance Index 2026?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Gir Wildlife Sanctuary established?

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which river is the Omkareshwar Floating Solar Park located?

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many Elephant Reserves does India have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Dirac Medal: recall

The Dirac Medal is an annual award named after the physicist Paul Dirac, whose legacy it is meant to honour. Dirac was one of the founders of modern quantum mechanics, and the medal is a tribute to his place in that history. The 2026 edition of the award went to the Indian physicist Dhar, who shared it with other scientists. The honour was given for pioneering work in statistical mechanics, which is the field of the group's research. Each recipient of the medal receives a cash prize along with the medal itself. The award is presented every year, and the 2026 edition is the one described here. The item is part of the AILET Corner in the August 2026 current affairs section, and its facts should be read as a set. Candidates revising this item should link the physicist's name, the field of the work and the name of the award. A short written summary, with each detail on its own line, makes these facts easier to recall before an examination. Repeated practice with the same facts also helps in answering questions that test a detail not stated in the passage. The passage therefore gives the context of the award, while the exact figures are left for the reader to recall from the booklet.

Q1.

In which year was the Dirac Medal instituted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What cash prize, in US dollars, does each recipient receive along with the medal? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did Paul Dirac receive the Nobel Prize in Physics? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

With which physicist did Paul Dirac share his Nobel Prize in Physics? (surname only)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the full name of the Indian physicist who won the 2026 Dirac Medal?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many physicists, including Dhar, shared the 2026 Dirac Medal? (number)

Answer: _____